4.11 FOOD PRESERVATION

Foods after preparation should be stored at proper conditions to prevent spoilage and loss of nutritive value in it. There are various methods of storing numerous food items at suitable conditions.

Food preservation is known "as the science which deals with the process of prevention of decay or spoilage of food thus allowing it to be stored in a fit condition for future use". Preservation ensures that the quality, edibility and the nutritive value of the food remains intact.

Techniques of Food Preservation

Different methods are used to preserve the foods. A single method or combination of methods can be used.

Drying is the oldest method of food preservation. This method reduces water content which prevents bacterial growth. Sun and wind are both used for drying.



Freezing is keeping prepared food stuffs in cold storages. Freezing at low temperature prevents microbial growth, slowing of oxidation reactions.



Smoking is the process that cooks, food exposing it to the smoke from burning wood. Various methods of smoking are used like hot smoking, cold smoking, smoke roasting and smoke baking.



Vacuum packing creates a vacuum by making bags and bottles airtight. Since there is no oxygen in the created vacuum bacteria die. Usually used for dry fruit.



Salting and Pickling Salting removes moisture from foods like meat. Pickling means preserving food either in salt solution or vinegar. Salt kills and inhibits growth of microorganisms at 20% of concentration.



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